

Deploy to Render — manual setup

github.com/jhraihan/Medi-Desk · branch `main` · free tier · 3 resources created in order

Create them in this order. The web service needs the database URL, and the static site needs the web service URL, so each step depends on the one before it.

1 Postgres database

New + → Postgres

Field	Value
Name	<code>medidesk-db</code>
Database	<code>medidesk</code>
User	<code>medidesk</code>
Region	<code>Singapore</code> — use this same region for the web service
Plan	Free

Create Database, then wait for status **Available**.

Scroll to **Connections** and copy the **Internal Database URL**. You need it in step 2.

Copy the **Internal** URL, not the External one. Internal is faster, free of egress charges, and does not expire.

2 Web service (Django API)

New + → Web Service → connect Medi-Desk

Field	Value
Name	<code>medidesk-api</code>
Region	<code>Singapore</code> — must match the database
Branch	<code>main</code>
Root Directory	<i>leave empty</i>
Runtime	<code>Python 3</code>
Build Command	<code>./build.sh</code>
Start Command	<code>cd hms && gunicorn hms.wsgi:application --bind 0.0.0.0:\$PORT --workers 2</code>
Plan	Free

Environment variables

Open **Advanced** → **Add Environment Variable** for each:

Key	Value
PYTHON_VERSION	3.12.7
SECRET_KEY	generate your own — see below the table
DEBUG	False
DATABASE_URL	the Internal Database URL from step 1
ALLOWED_HOSTS	localhost,127.0.0.1
TIME_ZONE	Asia/Dhaka
CORS_ALLOWED_ORIGINS	leave for step 4
CSRF_TRUSTED_ORIGINS	leave for step 4

Generating SECRET_KEY

Run this locally and paste the output as the value:

```
python -c "from django.core.management.utils import get_random_secret_key;
print(get_random_secret_key())"
```

Keep this value out of git and out of any shared document. It signs every JWT and session cookie, so anyone holding it can forge a login. Set it only in Render's **Environment** tab. Changing it later logs everyone out.

Health check

Under **Advanced**, set **Health Check Path** to `/healthz/`

Create Web Service. First build takes 5–10 minutes.

When it shows **Live**, copy its URL from the top of the page — e.g. `https://medidesk-api.onrender.com`

3 Static site (React app)

New + → Static Site → connect Medi-Desk

Field	Value
Name	medidesk-web
Branch	main
Root Directory	frontend
Build Command	npm ci && npm run build
Publish Directory	dist

Environment variables

Key	Value
NODE_VERSION	22
VITE_API_URL	your step 2 URL + /api/v1/ https://medidesk-api.onrender.com/api/v1/

VITE_API_URL must end with /api/v1/ including the final slash. Without it every API call returns 404.

Create Static Site. Build takes about a minute.

Rewrite rule — required

After it deploys: Redirects/Rewrites → Add Rule

Field	Value
Source	/*
Destination	/index.html
Action	Rewrite

Without this, refreshing any page other than the home page returns 404.

Copy the static site URL — e.g. https://medidesk-web.onrender.com

4 Connect the two

Go back to medidesk-api → Environment and add the two variables you skipped, using your **static site** URL:

Key	Value
CORS_ALLOWED_ORIGINS	https://medidesk-web.onrender.com
CSRF_TRUSTED_ORIGINS	https://medidesk-web.onrender.com

Save Changes — the service redeploys automatically.

Include https:// and **no** trailing slash. A bare hostname is rejected and the browser blocks every request.

5 Create the admin user

medidesk-api → Shell:

```
cd hms
python manage.py createsuperuser
```

6 Load demo data (optional)

```
cd hms
python manage.py seed_demo
```

All five accounts use password `Demo!2345`: `hospital_admin`, `aisha`, `reception`, `pharmacy`, `rafi`.

7 Verify

Open	Expect
<code><api>/healthz/</code>	<code>{"status": "ok"}</code>
<code><api>/admin/</code>	Django login, styled
<code><web></code> → log in	Dashboard loads

8 If it fails

Symptom	Fix
<code>./build.sh: Permission denied</code>	<code>git update-index --chmod=+x build.sh</code> , push
CORS error in console	Step 4 — check scheme and exact match
All API calls 404	Step 3 — missing trailing slash on <code>VITE_API_URL</code>
Changed <code>VITE_API_URL</code> , no effect	It is baked into the bundle. Manual Deploy → Clear build cache & deploy
Admin unstyled	<code>collectstatic</code> failed; read the build log
Deep-link refresh 404s	The rewrite rule in step 3 is missing
Database connection refused	Web service and database are in different regions

9 Known limits

- API sleeps after 15 min idle — next request takes ~50 s.
- Free Postgres is deleted after 90 days. Back up with `pg_dump "$DATABASE_URL" > backup.sql`.
- Uploaded documents are lost on every redeploy.

Redeploy = `git push origin main`. Migrations run automatically. Settings for all three services are also committed in `render.yaml`.